

biggest strength of PNGs are that they are compressed in a format that is 'lossless', which means they will retain all the digital detail. But unlike the some of the previously covered formats, this quality does not mean large and bulky file sizes. PNG allows for pages to load quickly, making it the more efficient choice. PNG files also allow for partial or total transparency, which means they are an ideal choice for logos or overlays.

Pros:

- Lossless compression
- Transparency is maintained making it ideal for logos or overlays

Cons:

- Quality will never be high enough for printing even at small sizes

BMP

Another one of these lossless formats is BMP and this was invented by tech giant Microsoft. While initially it was only available for use on their own platforms, it is now recognized even by programs on Macbooks as well. BMPs are large file sizes as colour data is saved in each individual pixel in the image without any compression. Due to this very reason, they provide high quality digital files which can be great for print. But their large file sizes mean they are not a great idea for web usage.

Pros:

- High quality images mean they are good for printing

Cons:

- Large file sizes = Higher amount of storage needed

PSD

Adobe Photoshop uses this format as its default format to save data. The biggest advantage of PSD files is that they allow for editing on specific layers and not the main image. This is what makes it essential if you are looking to manipulate the original photograph with features like retouching. But once you flatten a layered PSD file, all the layers will be merged and this process cannot be undone. So ensure that you save a copy of your file as a PSD file before you start flattening.

Pros:

- Ability to manipulate the image extensively on separate layers
- Once the image is ready it can be re-saved as any other file format

Cons:

- Layered files can be large in size